

University of North Texas at Dallas
Syllabus for Fall 2025

EDUC 2301 Special Populations

Department of	Teacher Education
Instructor Name	Christina Salazar, Ph.D.
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Office Hours	Wednesday 2:30 PM - 4 PM Thursday 1 PM - 4 PM
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Course Format/Structure	In person
Classroom Location	FH 306
Class Meeting Days & Times	TuTh 8:30AM - 9:50AM
Course Catalog Description	An enriched, integrated pre-service course and content experience that provides an overview of schooling and classrooms from the perspectives of language, gender, socioeconomic status, ethnic and academic diversity, and equity with an emphasis on factors that facilitate learning.
Prerequisites	Must be an Education Major
Corequisites	None

Required Text	<i>Teaching in Inclusive Classrooms Third Edition</i> by Diane Pedrotty Bryant (Author), Deborah D. Smith (Author), Brian R. Bryant (Author) 978-1071834954
Recommended Text & References	Will be provided by the professor.
Access to Learning Resources	UNT Dallas Library: Phone: (972) 338-1616; Website URL: http://www.untdallas.edu/library UNT Dallas Bookstore: Phone: (972) 780-3652; Website URL: http://www.untdallas.edu/bookstore Email: untdallas@bkstr.com
Canvas Resources Supported Browsers: • Updated Chrome Supported Devices: • iPhone • Android • Chromebook <i>Note: Tablet users can use the Canvas app</i>	Getting Help with Canvas: Canvas 24/7 Phone Support for Students: 1-833-668-8634 Canvas Help Resources: Canvas Student Guide - https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10701 For additional assistance, contact Student Assistance (UNT Dallas Distance Learning): DAL1, Room 157 Phone: 972-338-5580 Email: distancelearning@untdallas.edu If you are working with Canvas 24/7 Support to resolve a technical issue, please keep me updated on the troubleshooting progress. If you have a course-related issue (e.g., course content, assignment trouble, quiz difficulties), please contact me during office hours or by email.

Course Overview

The goal of this course is to provide students with awareness and appreciation of special populations of K-12 students including English Language Learners, students with learning challenges, and students from a variety of cultural and socioeconomic backgrounds. Students will be assigned to a K-12 school and participate in observations of K-12 teaching. The course will help prepare students for the Pedagogy and Professional Responsibilities teacher certification exam.

[Framework for Pedagogy and Professional Responsibilities EC-12 \(160\) The Domains](#)

Course Goals: The goals of this course are as follows:

1. Students will explore topics, strategies, skills, and resources with regard to special populations, and apply this information when working in early childhood, elementary, middle, and/or high schools.
2. Students will develop a knowledge of theories and practices of culturally appropriate school-based instruction, assessments, and interventions.
3. Students will explore educators' roles, functions, and professional and ethical practices.
4. Students will read research articles accurately and will understand their essential ideas and implications.

Learning Objectives/Outcomes:

At the end of this course, the student will

1. Understand, compare, critique, and apply key theories of learning and development (TExES PPR Competency 1).
2. Identify, understand, and use individual differences and contextual factors to promote the unique needs of all learners (TExES PPR Competency 2).
3. Understand, synthesize, and apply key constructs in instructional design, delivery, and assessment aligned with Texas statewide assessment program (TExES PPR Competency 3).
4. Demonstrate understanding of classrooms that foster learning, equity, and excellence and promotes a physical and emotional environment that are safe and productive (TExES PPR Competency 5).
5. Practice principles and strategies for communicating effectively in varied teaching and learning contexts (TExES PPR Competency 7).
6. Understand instructional techniques and strategies that engage students in the learning processes (TExES PPR Competency 8).
7. Understand the use of technology for planning, organizing, delivering, and evaluating instruction for all students (TExES PPR Competency 9).
8. Describe the characteristics of exceptional learners (e.g., Learning Disabilities, Gifted and Talented), including legal implications. (TExES PPR Competency 2)
9. Describe and analyze characteristics of diverse learners (e.g., language, gender, sexual orientation, race, and ethnicity) and how diversity impacts learning. (TExES PPR Competency 2)
10. Describe the impact of socio-economic status on learning and creating equitable classrooms. (TExES PPR Competency 2)

11. Demonstrate an understanding of the benefits and challenges of racial, ethnic, and other types of cultural diversity in the classroom. (TExES PPR Competency 2)

Course Outline

This schedule is subject to change by the instructor.

Week	Subject	Student To Do
1 Aug. 25 - Aug. 31	Course Introductions	Obtain Text
2 Sep. 1 - Sep. 7	Educational neutrality Ch. 1 INCLUSIVE TEACHING AS RESPONSIVE EDUCATION	1. Rd. Ch. 1 2. Reading Quiz
3 Sep. 8 - Sep. 14	<i>Asynchronous Week</i> PPR Competency 002: The teacher understands student diversity and knows how to plan learning experiences and design assessments that are responsive to differences among students and that promote all students' learning. Ch. 4 CULTURALLY AND LINGUISTICALLY DIVERSE LEARNERS AND FAMILIES AND GIFTED AND TALENTED LEARNERS	1. Rd. Ch. 4 2. Reading Quiz 3. Weekly Participation Assignment in Canvas
4 Sep. 15 - Sep. 21	PPR Competency 003: The teacher understands procedures for designing effective and coherent instruction and assessment based on appropriate learning goals and objectives. Ch. 7 DESIGNING AND DELIVERING DIFFERENTIATED INSTRUCTION	1. Rd. Ch. 7 2. Reading Quiz
5 Sep. 22 - Sep. 28	PPR Competency 004: The teacher understands learning processes and factors that impact student learning and demonstrates this knowledge by planning	1. Readings in Canvas 2. Reading Quiz 3. Differentiated Lesson Plan

	effective, engaging instruction and appropriate assessments. Constructivism	
6 Sep. 29 - Oct. 5	PPR Competency 013: The teacher understands and adheres to legal and ethical requirements for educators and is knowledgeable of the structure of education in Texas. Ch. 2 DELIVERY OF INDIVIDUALIZED SERVICES TO STUDENTS WITH DIFFERENT LEARNING NEEDS	1. Rd. Ch. 2 2. Reading Quiz
7 Oct. 6 - Oct. 12	Ch. 11 TEACHING READING Ch. 12 TEACHING WRITING OAR Resources from TEA	1. Rd. Ch. 11 2. Rd. Ch. 12 3. Reading Quiz
8 Oct. 13 - Oct. 19	<i>Asynchronous Week</i> Midterm	1. Midterm
9 Oct. 20 - Oct. 26	PPR Competency 007: The teacher understands and applies principles and strategies for communicating effectively in varied teaching and learning contexts. Ch. 13 TEACHING MATHEMATICS OAR Resources from TEA	1. Rd. Ch. 13 2. Reading Quiz
10 Oct. 27 - Nov. 2	PPR Competency 008: The teacher provides appropriate instruction that actively engages students in the learning process. Digital Literacy	1. Digital Literacy Pre-Assessment
11 Nov. 3 - Nov. 9	PPR Competency 009: The teacher incorporates the effective use of technology to plan, organize, deliver and evaluate instruction for all students. Digital Literacy	1. Digital Literacy Post-Assessment

12 Nov. 10 - Nov. 16	PPR Competency 010: The teacher monitors student performance and achievement; provides students with timely, high-quality feedback; and responds flexibly to promote learning for all students. Ch. 9 ASSESSMENT AND DATA-BASED DECISION MAKING	1. Rd. Ch. 9 2. Reading Quiz
13 Nov. 17 - Nov. 23	PPR Competency 011: The teacher understands the importance of family involvement in children's education and knows how to interact and communicate effectively with families. Ch. 3 DEVELOPING COLLABORATIVE PARTNERSHIPS IN SCHOOLS AND WITH FAMILIES <i>Discuss Inquiry and Inclusive Redesign Presentations</i>	1. Rd. Ch. 3 2. Reading Quiz
14 Nov. 24 - Nov. 30 Thanksgiving	<i>Asynchronous Week</i> PPR Competency 006: The teacher understands strategies for creating an organized and productive learning environment and for managing student behavior. PPR Competency 012: The teacher enhances professional knowledge and skills by effectively interacting with other members of the educational community and participating in various types of professional activities.	1. Weekly Participation Assignment in Canvas
15 Dec. 1 - Dec. 7 LRA 3rd - 6th	<i>Asynchronous Week</i> PPR Competency 001: The teacher understands human developmental processes and applies this knowledge to plan instruction	

	and ongoing assessment that motivate students and are responsive to their developmental characteristics and needs. PPR Competency 005: The teacher knows how to establish a classroom climate that fosters learning, equity and excellence and uses this knowledge to create a physical and emotional environment that is safe and productive.	
16 Dec. 8 - Dec. 13	Tuesday and Thursday Inquiry and Inclusive Redesign Presentations	1. Inquiry and Inclusive Redesign Presentations

Course Evaluation Methods

This course will utilize the following instruments to determine student grades and proficiency of the learning outcomes for the course.

Grading Matrix:

Instrument	Point Value
Class Participation (attendance, in class activities, 14 weeks x 30 points)	420
Digital Literacy Pre-Assessment	40
Digital Literacy Post-Assessment	80
Reading Quizzes (9 Assignments/ 20 points each)	180
Midterm Exam	80
Differentiated Lesson Plan	100
Inquiry and Inclusive Redesign	100
Total	1000

GRADE DETERMINATION:

A = 90% or better, 900-1000 points

B = 80 – 89 %, 800-899 points

C = 70 – 79 %, 700-799 points

D = 60 – 69 %, 600-699 points

F = less than 60%, less than 600 points

Description of Assignments

1. **Reading Quizzes:** For most weeks, you will have readings and you must complete a reading quiz. The quiz is due Wednesdays at midnight. It is open book/open note but will require a lockdown browser. That means you should purchase a physical copy of the book or take/print physical notes. Technical issues are not an excuse for missed/late quizzes. Take the quiz early to prevent issues. Use a campus computer if necessary.
2. **Differentiated Lesson Plan:** This assignment will give you practical experience in designing and delivering a differentiated lesson that meets the diverse needs of students in a classroom
3. **Inquiry and Inclusive Redesign:** In this culminating project, you will present a synthesis of the semester's learning.

Course-Specific Policies

Missing Class

- Classroom participation is the major source of points in this course. My goal is that we attend class together and spend time learning, thinking, applying, and co-creating knowledge in this course. This is messy and imperfect but, if you are present and doing, you will receive the full points for participation.
- If you miss a class, you can recover points for participation by creating an infographic about the topic chapter.
 - If you have documentation of an emergency, you will receive 70% (max) credit for participation for the week.
 - Without documentation, you will receive 40% (max) credit for participation for the week.
- IF YOU MISS MORE THAN 3 CLASSES, YOU WILL RECEIVE AN "F" FOR THE COURSE. I want to be as flexible and supportive of you as possible but, at this point, you will have missed an excessive amount of coursework and I cannot guarantee your preparation in the subject matter.

Assignment Submission Guidelines:

- Students are responsible for ensuring that assignments are submitted to the correct place and in the correct format (.pdf). Assignments that are submitted to the wrong place or in the wrong format will be considered late or will not be accepted.
- All assignments must be submitted to Canvas unless the instructor gives other directions in the syllabus or in class or you have made prior arrangements with the instructor.
- A difficulty with technology is **NOT** an excuse to turn in an assignment late. Please plan ahead.

- All assignments must be submitted as **PDF documents**.
- Papers are expected to have minimal spelling and grammar mistakes. Students are encouraged to take advantage of the services offered at the UNT Dallas Writing Center. Papers with spelling errors or too many other errors may be rejected, and permission to resubmit the assignment will be at the instructor's discretion.

Late Assignments:

- Coursework is expected to be submitted on time.
- There will be a 10% reduction of the assignment grade for every day the assignment is late. For example: You score 100% on an assignment. It is three days late. The score is reduced by 30%. You receive 70%.
- Assignments more than 5 days late will not be accepted and you will receive a 0% on that assignment.
- **Life happens!** If you have extenuating circumstances, please contact Dr. Salazar asap so we can create a plan for you to be successful.

University Policies and Procedures

No student should go hungry. If you face hunger, need access to immediate food, or struggle to afford food, you are not alone. Our campus offers free food and resources to students at the [Trailblazer Care Pantry](#). For help, visit the pantry on the second floor of the Student Center (behind the speaking lab) any day between noon and 4pm. If you arrive before or after hours, please call [972-338-1816](tel:972-338-1816) for access or contact: carepantry@untdallas.edu

Additionally, your mental health and wellbeing is critical to your success. If you have any questions, concerns, or simply need support in any way, please contact the or via email Counseling.Wellness@untdallas.edu

Course Evaluations:

Student evaluations of teaching effectiveness is a requirement for all organized classes at UNT Dallas. This short survey will be made available to you at the end of the semester via your campus email, providing you a chance to comment on how this class is taught. I will not have access to the results of the evaluations until after final grades have been posted. I am very interested in the feedback I get from students, as I work to continually improve my teaching. I consider students' evaluations to be an important part of your participation in this class.

Attendance & Participation:

The University attendance policy is in effect for this course. Please refer to Policy 7.005 Student Attendance at <https://www.untdallas.edu/hr/upol>.

Exam Policy:

Exams should be taken as scheduled. No makeup examinations will be allowed except for documented emergencies (See Policy 7.005 Student Attendance at <https://www.untdallas.edu/hr/upol>).

Students with Disabilities (ADA Compliance)

The University of North Texas Dallas faculty is committed to complying with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA). Students with documented disabilities are responsible for informing faculty of their needs for reasonable accommodations and providing written authorized documentation. Grades assigned before an accommodation is provided will not be changed as accommodations are not retroactive. For more information, you may visit Section 504 Coordinator, Cynthia Suarez, at 972-338-1777 or email cynthia.suarez@untDallas.edu.

Canvas Instructure Accessibility Statement:

University of North Texas at Dallas is committed to ensuring that online and hybrid courses are usable by all students and faculty including those with disabilities. If you encounter any difficulties with technologies, please contact our ITSS Department. To better assist them, you would want to have the operating system, web browser and information on any assistive technology being used. The Canvas Instructure Accessibility Statement is provided at <https://www.canvaslms.com/accessibility>.

NOTE: Additional instructional technology tools, such as Turnitin, Respondus, Panopto, and publisher cartridge content (i.e. MyLab, Pearson, etc.) may NOT be fully ADA compliant. Please contact our Disability Office should you require additional assistance utilizing any of these tools.

Academic Integrity:

Academic integrity is a hallmark of higher education. You are expected to abide by the University's code of Academic Integrity policy. Any person suspected of academic dishonesty (i.e., cheating or plagiarism) will be handled in accordance with the University's policies and procedures. Refer to the UNT Dallas Academic Integrity Policy in the appropriate Catalog at <http://dallascatalog.unt.edu>.

Academic dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, cheating, plagiarizing, fabrication of information or citations, facilitating acts of dishonesty by others, having unauthorized possession of examinations, submitting work of another person or work previously used without informing the instructor, or tampering with the academic work of other students.

AI: Do not turn in anything produced or written by artificial intelligence. Rewording and turning in an AI generated text is not permitted.

Web-based Plagiarism Detection:

Please be aware that in some courses, students may be required to submit written assignments to Turnitin, a web-based plagiarism detection service, or another method. If submitting to Turnitin, please remove your title page and other personal information.

Diversity/Tolerance Policy:

Students are encouraged to contribute their perspectives and insights to class discussions. However, offensive & inappropriate language (swearing) and remarks offensive to others of particular nationalities, ethnic groups, sexual preferences, religious groups, genders, or other ascribed statuses will not be tolerated. Disruptions which violate the Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct will be referred to the Dean of Students as the instructor deems appropriate (UNTD Policy 7.001 found at <https://www.untDallas.edu/hr/upol>).

Online "Netiquette":

In any social interaction, certain rules of etiquette are expected and contribute to more enjoyable and productive communication. Emails, Discussion Board messages and/or any other forms of written communication in the online environment should use proper "netiquette" (i.e., no writing in all caps (usually denotes yelling), no curse words, and no "flaming" messages (angry, personal attacks).

Racial, ethnic, or gender slurs will not be tolerated, nor will pornography of any kind.

Any violation of online netiquette may result in a loss of points or removal from the course and referral to the Dean of Students, including warnings and other sanctions in accordance with the University's policies and procedures. Refer to the Student Code of Student Rights Responsibilities and Conduct. Respect is a given principle in all online communication. Therefore, please be sure to proofread all of your written communication prior to submission.

Classroom Disruption:

Students are expected to engage with the instructor and other students in this class in a respectful and civil manner at all times to promote a classroom environment that is conducive to teaching and learning. Students who engage in disruptive behavior will be directed to leave the classroom. A student who is directed to leave class due to disruptive behavior is not permitted to return to class until the student meets with a representative from the Dean of Students Office. It is the student's responsibility to meet with the Dean of Students before class meets again and to provide the instructor confirmation of the meeting. A student who is directed to leave class will be assigned an unexcused absence for that class period and any other classes the student misses as a result of not meeting with the Dean of Students. The student is responsible for material missed during all absences and the instructor is not responsible for providing missed material. In addition, the student will be assigned a failing grade for assignments, quizzes or examinations missed and will not be allowed to make up the work.

The Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct (UNTD Policy 7.001 found at <https://www.untDallas.edu/hr/upol>) describes disruption as the obstructing or interfering with university functions or activity, including any behavior that interferes with students, faculty, or staff access to an appropriate educational environment. Examples of disruptive behavior that may result in a student being directed to leave the classroom include but are not limited to: failure to comply with reasonable directive of University officials, action or combination of

actions that unreasonably interfere with, hinder, obstruct, or prevent the right of others to freely participate, threatening, assaulting, or causing harm to oneself or to another, uttering any words or performing any acts that cause physical injury, or threaten any individual, or interfere with any individual's rightful actions, and harassment. You are encouraged to read the Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct for more information related to behaviors that could be considered disruptive.

Bad Weather Policy:

Campus facilities will close and operations will be suspended when adverse weather and/or safety hazards exist on the UNTD campus or if travel to the campus is deemed dangerous as the result of ice, sleet or snow. In the event of a campus closure, the Marketing and Communication Department will report closure information to all appropriate major media by 7 a.m. That department will also update the UNTD website, Facebook and Twitter with closing information as soon as it is possible. For more information please refer to <http://www.untDallas.edu/police/resources/notifications>.

Inclement Weather and Online Classes:

Online classes may or may not be affected by campus closures due to inclement weather. Unless otherwise notified by your instructor via e-mail, online messaging, or online announcement, students should assume that assignments are due as scheduled.

Technology Assistance: In order to successfully access the materials in Canvas, UNT Dallas advises that your computer be equipped with the minimum system requirements listed on the first page of the syllabus.

If you experience difficulty accessing or using components of the course, try using Google Chrome browser. If you still experience technical difficulties, first, notify your instructor.

If the problem is still not resolved, call Distance Learning at the phone number listed on the first page of the syllabus. Also, no matter what browser you use, always enable pop-ups.

For more information see:

- UNT Dallas Canvas Technical Requirements:
<https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10721>
- Canvas Instructure Support & Unsupported Operating Systems:
<https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10720>